# 白蛇传

断桥上的一把伞

# The Legend of the White Snake

*One umbrella on the Broken Bridge*

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Footnotes mark names, festival terms and words above HSK 3 (HSK 3.0 lists: github.com/ivankra/hsk30, MIT).

1 杭州[†]的西湖[‡]非常有名。有人说，西湖晴天的时候好看，下雨的时候更好看。林阳[§]和周雨[¶]是一对年轻人，今年五月，他们第一次一起来杭州旅游。周雨曾经在书上看过很多西湖的照片，这次终于可以自己来看看了。

## 西湖的雨

2 那天早上天气很好，太阳很大。他们在湖边走着，一边走一边照相。走到一座石桥上的时候，天突然黑了，接着就下起了大雨。“快！伞[*]！”周雨叫了起来。林阳从包里拿出一把伞，打开，两个人站在了伞下。伞不大，两个人只好站得很近。“你只带了一把伞吗？”周雨问。“这个……只有一把。”林阳说，脸有点儿红。

† 杭州 *Hángzhōu* Hangzhou
‡ 西湖 *Xī Hú* West Lake
§ 林阳 *Lín Yáng* Lin Yang
¶ 周雨 *Zhōu Yǔ* Zhou Yu
* 伞 *sǎn* umbrella

Hangzhou's West Lake is very famous. People say West Lake is beautiful on 1
a sunny day, and even more beautiful in the rain. Lin Yang and Zhou Yu were a young couple. This May they came to Hangzhou together for the first time. Zhou Yu had once seen lots of photos of West Lake in books, and now at last she could come and see it for herself.

## Rain on West Lake

That morning the weather was fine and the sun was strong. They walked 2
along the lake, taking pictures as they went. When they reached a stone bridge, the sky suddenly went dark, and then it began to pour. "Quick! The umbrella!" Zhou Yu cried. Lin Yang took an umbrella out of his bag and opened it, and the two of them stood under it. It wasn't big, so they had to stand very close. "You only brought one umbrella?" Zhou Yu asked. "Well... just the one," said Lin Yang, his face turning a little red.

3 桥上还有不少游客，他们没有伞†，衣服很快就被雨打得都是水。桥边有一位导游‡，正在给一群游客讲着什么。她看见林阳§和周雨¶，笑着说：“你们知道吗？你们现在站的这座桥，叫断桥*。一千多年来，很多人都曾经在这里等雨停。”周雨看了看桥：“这座桥好好的，没有断啊。为什么叫断桥？”

4 导游说：“这个问题，很多游客都问过。有人说，冬天下雪以后，桥的一边有雪，一边没有，从很远的地方看，桥好像断了。不过，大家记得这座桥，不是因为雪，是因为一个故事。”“什么故事？”“白蛇传#。你们曾经听过吗？”林阳说：“小时候在电视上看过，可是差不多都忘了。”“那正好。雨这么大，你们也走不了，我给大家讲讲吧。”

† 伞 *sǎn* umbrella
‡ 导游 *dǎoyóu* tour guide
§ 林阳 *Lín Yáng* Lin Yang
¶ 周雨 *Zhōu Yǔ* Zhou Yu
* 断桥 *Duàn Qiáo* the Broken Bridge
# 白蛇传 *Báishé Zhuàn* The Legend of the White Snake

There were plenty of other visitors on the bridge. They had no umbrellas, 3
and the rain soon soaked their clothes. By the bridge a tour guide was telling a group of visitors something. She saw Lin Yang and Zhou Yu and said with a smile, "Do you know? The bridge you're standing on is called the Broken Bridge. For more than a thousand years, people have waited here for the rain to stop." Zhou Yu looked at the bridge. "This bridge is perfectly fine. It isn't broken. Why is it called the Broken Bridge?"

The guide said, "Lots of visitors ask that. Some say that in winter, after it 4
snows, there's snow on one side of the bridge and none on the other, so from a distance it looks as if the bridge is broken. But people don't remember this bridge because of the snow. They remember it because of a story." "What story?" "The Legend of the White Snake. Have you ever heard it?" Lin Yang said, "I saw it on TV when I was little, but I've forgotten almost all of it." "Perfect. It's raining so hard that you can't go anywhere anyway. Let me tell it to everyone."

# 一把伞[1]

很久很久以前，山里住着两条蛇[2]，一条是白色的，一条是青色的。它们在山里修炼[3]了很多年。白蛇[4]修炼了一千年，终于能变成人了。她变成了一个美丽的姑娘，叫白素贞[5]。青蛇[6]也变成了一个姑娘，叫小青[7]。她们觉得人的世界很有意思，就一起来到了杭州[8]的西湖[9]。

那是一个春天，湖边的人很多。白素贞和小青走到断桥[10]上的时候，天突然下起了大雨。她们没有带伞，只能站在雨里。这时候，一个年轻人走了过来。他叫许仙[11]，在一家药店工作。他看见两个姑娘没有伞，就把自己的伞借给了她们，自己站在雨里。白素贞问他住在哪儿，说以后一定把伞还给他。

1 伞 *sǎn* umbrella
2 蛇 *shé* snake
3 修炼 *xiūliàn* to cultivate magic powers
4 白蛇 *Báishé* the White Snake
5 白素贞 *Bái Sùzhēn* Bai Suzhen
6 青蛇 *Qīngshé* the Green Snake
7 小青 *Xiǎo Qīng* Xiao Qing
8 杭州 *Hángzhōu* Hangzhou
9 西湖 *Xī Hú* West Lake
10 断桥 *Duàn Qiáo* the Broken Bridge
11 许仙 *Xǔ Xiān* Xu Xian

## An Umbrella

Long, long ago, two snakes lived in the mountains. One was white, and one was green. They practised magic in the mountains for many years. The White Snake practised for a thousand years, and at last she could turn into a human. She became a beautiful young woman named Bai Suzhen. The Green Snake also became a young woman, named Xiao Qing. They found the human world very interesting, so together they came to West Lake in Hangzhou. 5

It was spring, and the lakeside was crowded. Just as Bai Suzhen and Xiao Qing reached the Broken Bridge, it suddenly began to pour. They had no umbrella, and could only stand there in the rain. Just then a young man came over. His name was Xu Xian, and he worked in a pharmacy. When he saw the two young women had no umbrella, he lent them his own and stood in the rain himself. Bai Suzhen asked where he lived and said she would be sure to return the umbrella. 6

6 第二天，她真的去还伞[1]了。就这样，两个人认识了。后来，他们常常见面，越来越喜欢对方。没过多久，他们就结婚了。

7 结婚以后，白素贞[2]和许仙[3]一起开了一家药店。白素贞懂很多药，也会看病。没有钱的人来看病，她常常不要钱。药店的生意越来越好，大家都说，许仙找到了一个好太太。

8 “等一下，”周雨[4]说，“白素贞是蛇[5]，许仙知道吗？”“不知道。”导游[6]说，“虽然他们在一起生活了很久，但是许仙一直不知道自己的太太到底是谁。”林阳[7]小声对周雨说：“你呢？你不会也是一条蛇吧？”周雨笑着打了他一下。

1 伞 *sǎn* umbrella
2 白素贞 *Bái Sùzhēn* Bai Suzhen
3 许仙 *Xǔ Xiān* Xu Xian
4 周雨 *Zhōu Yǔ* Zhou Yu
5 蛇 *shé* snake
6 导游 *dǎoyóu* tour guide
7 林阳 *Lín Yáng* Lin Yang

The next day she really did go and return it. That was how the two of them met. After that they saw each other often and grew fonder and fonder of each other. Before long they were married. 6

After the wedding, Bai Suzhen and Xu Xian opened a pharmacy together. Bai Suzhen knew a great deal about medicine and could treat the sick too. When poor people came to see her, she often didn't charge them. Business at the pharmacy got better and better, and everyone said Xu Xian had found himself a good wife. 7

"Wait a moment," said Zhou Yu. "Bai Suzhen was a snake. Did Xu Xian know?" "No," said the guide. "Although they lived together for a long time, Xu Xian never knew who his wife really was." Lin Yang whispered to Zhou Yu, "What about you? You're not a snake too, are you?" Zhou Yu laughed and gave him a slap. 8

# 法海[1]

9 “这个时候，有一个人出现了。”导游[2]说，“他叫法海，是金山寺[3]的和尚[4]。”法海的法力[5]很大。他一看见许仙[6]，就知道许仙的太太不是人，是一条蛇[7]。他对许仙说：“你的太太是蛇变的。你要是不相信，端午节[8]那天，让她喝一杯雄黄酒[9]，你就知道了。”许仙不相信。可是他心里还是有一点儿害怕：我的太太到底是什么人？

10 端午节到了，家家都喝雄黄酒。许仙也拿出酒来，让白素贞[10]喝。白素贞知道，蛇不能喝这种酒。可是她不想让许仙不高兴，就喝了一杯。喝完以后，她觉得很不舒服，就回房间睡觉了。过了一会儿，许仙给她送药。他一开门，看见床上没有太太，只有一条很大的白蛇[11]！许仙被吓[12]死了。

1 法海 *Fǎhǎi* Fahai, a Buddhist monk
2 导游 *dǎoyóu* tour guide
3 金山寺 *Jīnshān Sì* Jinshan Temple
4 和尚 *héshang* Buddhist monk
5 法力 *fǎlì* magic power
6 许仙 *Xǔ Xiān* Xu Xian
7 蛇 *shé* snake
8 端午节 *Duānwǔjié* Dragon Boat Festival
9 雄黄酒 *xiónghuángjiǔ* realgar wine
10 白素贞 *Bái Sùzhēn* Bai Suzhen
11 白蛇 *báishé* white snake
12 吓 *xià* to frighten

## Fahai

"At this point, someone appeared," said the guide. "His name was Fahai, 9
a monk from Jinshan Temple." Fahai had great magic powers. The moment he saw Xu Xian, he knew that Xu Xian's wife was not a human but a snake. He said to Xu Xian, "Your wife is a snake in disguise. If you don't believe me, on the day of the Dragon Boat Festival, have her drink a cup of realgar wine, and you'll see." Xu Xian didn't believe him. But deep down he was still a little afraid: who on earth was his wife?

The Dragon Boat Festival came, and every family drank realgar wine. Xu 10
Xian brought out the wine too and asked Bai Suzhen to drink. Bai Suzhen knew that a snake must not drink this kind of wine. But she didn't want to upset Xu Xian, so she drank a cup. Afterwards she felt very unwell and went to her room to lie down. A little later Xu Xian brought her some medicine. When he opened the door, there was no wife on the bed, only an enormous white snake! Xu Xian was frightened to death.

11 白素贞[1]睡了很久。她起来以后，看见许仙[2]死了，哭得非常伤心。她听说很远的山上有一种仙草[3]，能让死了的人活过来。她不怕危险，一个人飞到山上去找。山上有人看着仙草，不让她拿。白素贞一次又一次地求他们，最后，他们被她感动了，把仙草给了她。许仙吃了仙草，终于活了过来。

12 可是法海[4]还是不让他们好好生活。他把许仙带到了金山寺[5]，不让他回家。白素贞和小青[6]去金山寺找许仙，法海不开门。白素贞非常生气，用法力[7]让大水越来越高，一直到了金山寺门口。这就是有名的“水漫金山[8]”。可是，很多人的房子也被大水破坏了。“那白素贞到底是好人还是坏人？”一个小男孩问。导游[9]想了想，说：“这个问题，大家已经问了几百年了。你说呢？”

1 白素贞 *Bái Sùzhēn* Bai Suzhen
2 许仙 *Xǔ Xiān* Xu Xian
3 仙草 *xiāncǎo* magic herb
4 法海 *Fǎhǎi* Fahai, a Buddhist monk
5 金山寺 *Jīnshān Sì* Jinshan Temple
6 小青 *Xiǎo Qīng* Xiao Qing
7 法力 *fǎlì* magic power
8 水漫金山 *shuǐ màn Jīnshān* flooding Jinshan Temple
9 导游 *dǎoyóu* tour guide

Bai Suzhen slept for a long time. When she got up and saw that Xu Xian 11
was dead, she wept bitterly. She had heard that on a faraway mountain there grew a magic herb that could bring the dead back to life. Not caring about the danger, she flew to the mountain alone to find it. The mountain had guards watching over the herb, and they wouldn't let her take it. Bai Suzhen begged them again and again, until at last they were moved and gave her the herb. Xu Xian ate the herb and at last came back to life.

But Fahai still wouldn't let them live in peace. He took Xu Xian away to 12
Jinshan Temple and wouldn't let him go home. Bai Suzhen and Xiao Qing went to Jinshan Temple to find Xu Xian, but Fahai wouldn't open the gate. Bai Suzhen was furious. With her magic she made the water rise higher and higher until it reached the temple gate. This is the famous "Flooding of Jinshan". But the flood also destroyed many people's houses. "So is Bai Suzhen a good person or a bad person?" a little boy asked. The guide thought for a moment and said, "People have been asking that for hundreds of years. What do you think?"

# 雷峰塔[1]

13 后来，白素贞[2]有了一个儿子。可是孩子出生没多久，法海[3]就来了。他用法力[4]把白素贞压在了西湖[5]边的雷峰塔下面。法海说："要等到西湖的水干了，雷峰塔倒了，你才能出来。"就这样，白素贞被压在塔[6]下，很多很多年都出不来。

14 "那她后来出来了吗？"周雨[7]问。导游[8]说："有的故事说，她的儿子长大以后考上了状元[9]，来到塔前，救出了妈妈。也有的故事说，小青[10]又练了很多年，最后打过了法海，把白素贞救了出来。""那到底哪个是真的？"林阳[11]问。导游笑了："这是故事啊，你喜欢哪个，哪个就是真的。不过，雷峰塔真的曾经倒过。

1 雷峰塔 *Léifēng Tǎ* Leifeng Pagoda
2 白素贞 *Bái Sùzhēn* Bai Suzhen
3 法海 *Fǎhǎi* Fahai, a Buddhist monk
4 法力 *fǎlì* magic power
5 西湖 *Xī Hú* West Lake
6 塔 *tǎ* pagoda
7 周雨 *Zhōu Yǔ* Zhou Yu
8 导游 *dǎoyóu* tour guide
9 状元 *zhuàngyuán* top scholar in the imperial exam
10 小青 *Xiǎo Qīng* Xiao Qing
11 林阳 *Lín Yáng* Lin Yang

## Leifeng Pagoda

Later Bai Suzhen had a son. But not long after the baby was born, Fahai came. With his magic he pinned Bai Suzhen beneath Leifeng Pagoda beside West Lake. Fahai said, "Not until West Lake runs dry and Leifeng Pagoda falls will you come out." And so Bai Suzhen lay trapped under the pagoda, unable to get out for years and years. 13

"So did she ever get out?" Zhou Yu asked. The guide said, "In some versions, her son grew up, came first in the imperial examination, and went to the pagoda and rescued his mother. In others, Xiao Qing trained for many more years, finally beat Fahai, and set Bai Suzhen free." "So which one is true?" Lin Yang asked. The guide laughed. "It's a story. Whichever one you like is the true one. But Leifeng Pagoda really did fall down once. 14

14 一九二四年，老雷峰塔[1]倒了。那时候，很多人说：白素贞[2]终于出来了！现在的雷峰塔，是二〇〇二年新建的。”

15 说着说着，雨小了。太阳从云里出来了，湖上一片亮光。导游[3]指着湖的对面说：“你们看，那就是雷峰塔。”林阳[4]和周雨[5]向湖对面看去，那边的小山上，有一座高高的塔[6]，在太阳下很好看。游客们慢慢地走了。林阳把伞[7]收了起来，想放回包里。

16 这时候，周雨看见林阳的包里还有一把伞。“林阳！你的包里怎么还有一把？你到底带了几把伞？”林阳的脸一下就红了：“两把……我想，许仙[8]能借伞给白素贞，我也能……跟你一起打一把伞。”周雨看着他，笑了：“虽然你不是许仙，但是你比许仙还会想办法。”

1 雷峰塔 *Léifēng Tǎ* Leifeng Pagoda
2 白素贞 *Bái Sùzhēn* Bai Suzhen
3 导游 *dǎoyóu* tour guide
4 林阳 *Lín Yáng* Lin Yang
5 周雨 *Zhōu Yǔ* Zhou Yu
6 塔 *tǎ* pagoda
7 伞 *sǎn* umbrella
8 许仙 *Xǔ Xiān* Xu Xian

In 1924 the old Leifeng Pagoda collapsed. At the time, many people said: Bai Suzhen is free at last! The Leifeng Pagoda you see today was newly built in 2002." 14

As she talked, the rain eased off. The sun came out from behind the clouds, and the lake was bright with light. The guide pointed across the lake. "Look, that's Leifeng Pagoda." Lin Yang and Zhou Yu looked across the lake. On a small hill over there stood a tall pagoda, lovely in the sunshine. The visitors slowly drifted away. Lin Yang folded the umbrella and went to put it back in his bag. 15

Just then Zhou Yu saw that there was another umbrella in Lin Yang's bag. "Lin Yang! Why is there another one in your bag? Just how many umbrellas did you bring?" Lin Yang's face went red at once. "Two... I thought, if Xu Xian could lend his umbrella to Bai Suzhen, then I could... share one umbrella with you." Zhou Yu looked at him and laughed. "You may not be Xu Xian, but you're even better at coming up with ideas than he was." 16

17 林阳[1]也笑了：“那你呢？你曾经说过，你最怕蛇[2]。你不会真的是……”“我要是白素贞[3]，”周雨[4]说，“一定先把你的第二把伞[5]送给西湖[6]！”两个人站在断桥[7]上，一起看着湖对面的雷峰塔[8]，都笑了。

1 林阳 *Lín Yáng* Lin Yang
2 蛇 *shé* snake
3 白素贞 *Bái Sùzhēn* Bai Suzhen
4 周雨 *Zhōu Yǔ* Zhou Yu
5 伞 *sǎn* umbrella
6 西湖 *Xī Hú* West Lake
7 断桥 *Duàn Qiáo* the Broken Bridge
8 雷峰塔 *Léifēng Tǎ* Leifeng Pagoda

Lin Yang laughed too. "And what about you? You once told me snakes scare you more than anything. You're not really..." "If I were Bai Suzhen," said Zhou Yu, "the first thing I'd do is give your second umbrella to West Lake!" The two of them stood on the Broken Bridge, looking together at Leifeng Pagoda across the lake, and both of them laughed. 17